



Virtual offices could be real

With gloves and armbands you could control virtual reality applications through finger-digit tracking thanks to Control VR <http://dgit.in/ControlVR>



NVIDIA Chromebook

Images of Acer's new chromebook have leaked online rumoured to have a NVIDIA chip under the hood <http://dgit.in/NVIDIAChromebook>

Ultrabooks



ACER TravelMate P645

The TravelMate is an Ultrabook for businessmen and it feels exactly like that. It's understated in design and did surprisingly well on the performance front, with the second-highest performance figures in this test.

Battery life was second only to the Inspiron, but only by a couple of minutes, which is a negligible difference. The keyboard and touchpad were a joy to use.

The laptop does suffer from a sub-par screen and soft speakers, which meant that movies and music weren't as much fun, also, the screen had the lowest brightness of any laptop in this test. As mentioned earlier, the omission of the touch-screen is a glaring oversight, especially considering the price.

This is a laptop we really wanted to like, but it's missing out on a few key feature to make it a killer deal.



LENOVO Yoga 2 13

Lenovo's always been known to make great laptops and the Yoga 2 is no exception. The hinge is already a Yoga series' trademark and we do love it, but even ignoring it, the Yoga 2 is still quite a beast.

The gorgeous screen is one of the first things that hits you when you look at the Yoga. It's about 30% brighter than the rest of the competition and features a great contrast ratio.

Performance figures are a little below average, especially the battery life. Strangely enough, while the maximum temperature hit was only 60°C, the laptop tends to get uncomfortably warm on your lap, which is about the only complaint we have against this device.

The machine is an excellent option for movie watching too, provided you get an extra set of speakers, courtesy the gorgeous, and very bright screen.



LENOVO IdeaPad Flex 2

The Flex 2 is, by itself, quite a decent device and the cheapest in this test, but also the most powerful, owing to the dedicated NVIDIA 820M GPU.

Our performance scores bear that out, with the device performing at least 25% better than most of the other devices here in 3DMark.

The battery life was surprisingly low, but that can be attributed, in part, to the Nvidia GPU that is brought to bear in certain segments of our battery life benchmark. Without GPU intensive tasks, you should see a slight improvement.

Sadly, the screen on the Flex 2 is sub-par, ruining an otherwise great device. We were impressed by the speakers, they're loud and severely lacking in bass, but at least don't distort noticeably at higher volumes. The keyboard is also among the better ones, better than on the Yoga 2 even.

NOTES ON PERFORMANCE:

It was interesting to note that the Intel i5 4200U was the de-facto CPU for almost all the devices in this comparison, testament to that CPU's capabilities. The drastic performance differences that we noted with the very same CPU were a bit unexpected, but we suspect that there is some sort of throttling involved to keep temperatures in check, maybe by limiting the boost clock.

Either way, this is not really a major issue as our tests are mostly indicative of performance under heavy load, which we believe, most of these devices will not be subject to. The PCMark 8 scores on the other hand, are a more realistic indicator of a system's performance and as can be seen from the results, there isn't much variation in performance between the various devices. Which is heartening as it means that as a buyer, you don't need to focus so much on the hardware anymore.

Another thing to note here is that our battery tests are synthetic benchmarks designed to drain the battery under heavy system loads and provide consistent results across devices to eliminate any bias. As a result, the test scores that you see indicate battery life under the worst possible conditions, meaning that real-world battery life will be much greater. A device that does well in our test will do exceptionally well in the real world.

Performance

PCMark 8.....	2073
3DMark Ice Storm.....	46776
Peacekeeper.....	4272
Cinebench R15.....	222cb
Sniper Elite V2.....	13.2fps
Contrast Ratio.....	94:1
Max. Temp.....	65 °C
Battery Life.....	251 minutes

Performance

PCMark 8.....	2027
3DMark Ice Storm.....	33897
Peacekeeper.....	2718
Cinebench R15.....	230cb
Sniper Elite V2.....	12.9fps
Contrast Ratio.....	611:1
Max. Temp.....	60 °C
Battery Life.....	167 minutes

Performance

PCMark 8.....	2081
3DMark Ice Storm.....	49029
Peacekeeper.....	4101
Cinebench R15.....	230cb
Sniper Elite V2.....	20fps
Contrast Ratio.....	71:1
Max. Temp.....	64 °C
Battery Life.....	125 minutes